

Summer 2026 Investing Quantitative Research Curriculum

Personal Self-Directed Program

June 7, 2026 – August 17, 2026

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1 Program Philosophy

The objective of this curriculum is not to maximize short-term trading gains.

The objective is to develop the knowledge, tools, habits, and research process necessary to become a capable capital allocator over the next 10–20 years.

Success is measured by:

- Ability to analyze businesses
- Ability to read financial statements
- Ability to build and test investment hypotheses
- Ability to write Python programs for investment research
- Ability to construct and maintain a disciplined portfolio process
- Creation of a permanent public or private GitHub portfolio documenting all work

2 Program Parameters

- Start Date: June 7, 2026
- End Date: August 17, 2026
- Duration: 10 Weeks
- Study Days: 6 Days per Week
- Daily Commitment: 2–3 Hours
- Target Hours: 150–180 Total Hours

3 Core Learning Objectives

By August 17, 2026, the goal is to be able to:

1. Read and interpret annual reports and financial statements.
2. Analyze business models and competitive advantages.
3. Build basic discounted cash flow models.
4. Write Python programs for stock analysis.
5. Build stock screeners.
6. Backtest simple quantitative investment strategies.
7. Maintain an investment journal.
8. Construct and follow an investment policy statement.
9. Produce professional investment research reports.

4 GitHub Repository Structure

Create a repository:

summer-investing-2026/

Structure:

summer-investing-2026/

README.md

notes/

company-research/

valuation-models/

python-projects/

backtests/

investment-journal/

portfolio/

resources/

4.1 Repository Rule

Every assignment must create a permanent artifact.

No learning activity should end without producing one of:

- Notes
- Research report
- Spreadsheet
- Python project
- Backtest
- Journal entry
- Portfolio document

5 Required Reading List

5.1 Core Books

1. The Psychology of Money — Morgan Housel
2. One Up On Wall Street — Peter Lynch
3. The Little Book of Common Sense Investing — John Bogle

5.2 Advanced Books

1. The Most Important Thing — Howard Marks
2. Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits — Philip Fisher
3. The Signal and the Noise — Nate Silver

6 Video Lecture Curriculum

6.1 Primary Instructor

Aswath Damodaran

Topics:

- Accounting
- Valuation
- Corporate Finance
- Business Analysis

6.2 Additional Resources

- MIT OpenCourseWare Statistics
- Kaggle Python Curriculum
- Python documentation
- Pandas documentation

7 Weekly Work Structure

Each week follows the same structure.

Day	Focus
Day 1	Reading and Notes
Day 2	Lecture and Notes
Day 3	Implementation Exercise

Day 4	Coding Work
Day 5	Research Work
Day 6	GitHub Deliverable and Reflection

8 Week-by-Week Timeline

8.1 Week 1: June 7 – June 13

Theme: What Is Investing?

Learning Goals:

- Understand ownership and equity
- Understand compounding
- Understand business value versus market price
- Learn how businesses create value

Reading:

- Psychology of Money Chapters 1–10

Lectures:

- Damodaran Intro to Valuation
- Buffett shareholder meeting excerpts

Assignments:

1. Analyze Apple
2. Analyze Costco

GitHub Deliverables:

`notes/psychology-of-money.md`

`company-research/apple/apple-overview.md`

`company-research/costco/costco-overview.md`

Deadline:

June 13

8.2 Week 2: June 14 – June 20

Theme: Financial Statements

Learning Goals:

- Income Statement
- Balance Sheet
- Cash Flow Statement

Reading:

- Continue One Up On Wall Street

Lectures:

- Damodaran Accounting Sessions

Assignments:

1. Microsoft Financial Analysis
2. Visa Financial Analysis

GitHub Deliverables:

`notes/accounting-notes.md`

`company-research/microsoft/financial-analysis.md`

`company-research/visa/financial-analysis.md`

Deadline:

June 20

8.3 Week 3: June 21 – June 27

Theme: Accounting Deep Dive

Learning Goals:

- ROE
- ROIC
- Operating Margin
- Free Cash Flow

Assignments:

Analyze five companies.

GitHub Deliverables:

`company-research/company-comparison.xlsx`

Columns:

- Revenue Growth
- Margin
- ROIC
- Free Cash Flow

Deadline:

June 27

8.4 Week 4: June 28 – July 4

Theme: Python Foundations

Learning Goals:

- Variables
- Loops
- Functions
- Lists
- Dictionaries

Course:

Automate the Boring Stuff with Python

Project:

Compound Interest Calculator

GitHub Deliverables:

`python-projects/compound-interest-calculator/`

`calculator.py`

`README.md`

`investment-journal/2026-06.md`

Deadline:

July 4

8.5 Week 5: July 5 – July 11

Theme: Data Analysis

Learning Goals:

- Pandas
- DataFrames
- CSV Manipulation
- Basic Visualization

Course:

Kaggle Python Curriculum

Project:

Stock Data Analysis Tool

GitHub Deliverables:

`python-projects/stock-data-analysis/`

Features:

- Download stock data
- Calculate returns
- Compare multiple securities
- Create charts

Deadline:

July 11

8.6 Week 6: July 12 – July 18

Theme: Market Data and Screening

Learning Goals:

- Financial APIs
- Data acquisition
- Screening methodology

Project:

Stock Screener

GitHub Deliverables:

`python-projects/screener/`

Features:

- Revenue Growth Screen
- Profitability Screen
- Momentum Screen

Deadline:

July 18

8.7 Week 7: July 19 – July 25

Theme: Statistics for Investing

Learning Goals:

- Expected Value
- Variance
- Standard Deviation
- Survivorship Bias

- Overfitting

Reading:

The Signal and the Noise

GitHub Deliverables:

`notes/statistics-notes.md`

`backtests/survivorship-bias.md`

Deadline:

July 25

8.8 Week 8: July 26 – August 1

Theme: Factor Investing

Learning Goals:

- Momentum
- Value
- Quality
- Size

Assignments:

Research each factor.

GitHub Deliverables:

`backtests/factor-research/`

`momentum.md`

`quality.md`

`value.md`

`size.md`

Deadline:

August 1

8.9 Week 9: August 2 – August 8

Theme: Backtesting

Learning Goals:

- Strategy Design
- Strategy Testing
- Risk Measurement

Project:
Momentum Backtest
GitHub Deliverables:

`python-projects/momentum-backtest/`

`backtests/momentum-study.md`

Required Metrics:

- Return
- Volatility
- Maximum Drawdown
- Sharpe Ratio

Deadline:
August 8

8.10 Week 10: August 9 – August 17

Theme: Valuation and Portfolio Construction

Learning Goals:

- Intrinsic Value
- DCF Modeling
- Portfolio Construction
- Risk Management

Assignments:

1. Alphabet DCF
2. Meta DCF
3. Three Full Investment Reports
4. Investment Policy Statement

GitHub Deliverables:

`valuation-models/alphabet-dcf.xlsx`

`valuation-models/meta-dcf.xlsx`

`company-research/alphabet/investment-thesis.md`

`company-research/meta/investment-thesis.md`

portfolio/investment-checklist.md

portfolio/investment-policy-statement.md

Deadline:

August 17

9 Investment Journal Requirements

Maintain monthly journals.

Required Prompts:

1. What did I learn?
2. What surprised me?
3. What mistakes did I make?
4. What assumptions were wrong?
5. What will I improve next month?

10 Capstone Requirements

To successfully complete the curriculum, the repository must contain:

10.1 Research

- 5+ company analyses
- 3 professional investment reports

10.2 Valuation

- 2 DCF models

10.3 Programming

- Compound Interest Calculator
- Stock Analysis Tool
- Stock Screener
- Momentum Backtest

10.4 Quantitative Research

- Factor research documents
- Survivorship bias paper
- Backtesting report

10.5 Portfolio Management

- Investment Checklist
- Investment Policy Statement
- Investment Journal

11 Success Criteria

By August 17, 2026, you should be capable of:

1. Reading annual reports independently.
2. Evaluating business quality.
3. Building valuation models.
4. Writing Python-based investment tools.
5. Testing investment ideas quantitatively.
6. Managing a small portfolio with a documented process.
7. Continuing to improve your framework over the next decade.